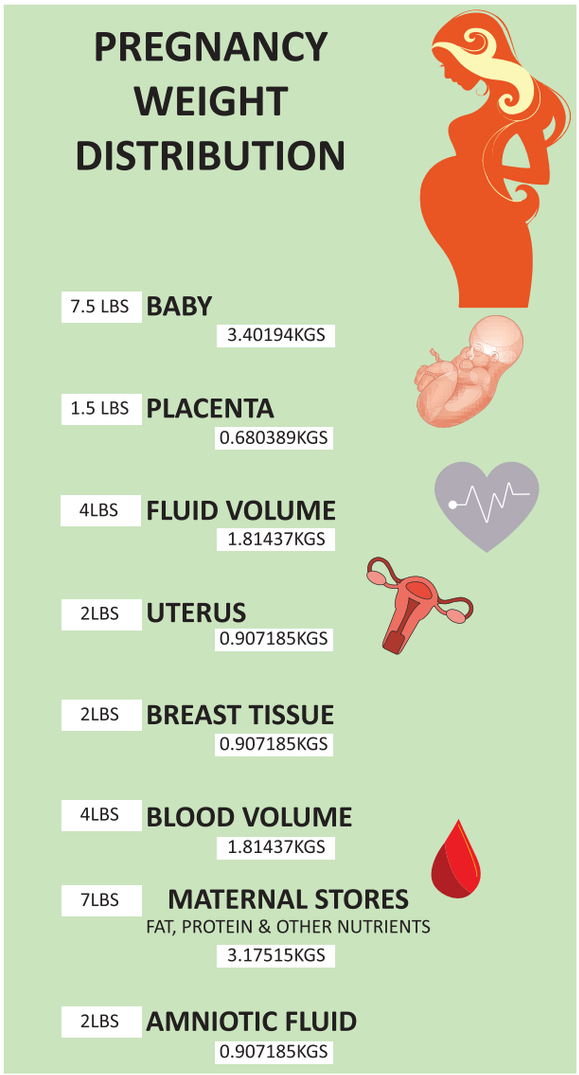
Abdomen- A brownish black pigmented line appears on the abdomen stretching from the Xiphisternum to the symphysis pubis. It will disappear after delivery (Linea Nigra).

Striae gravidarum-It is a specific form of scarring of the abdominal skin area due to rapid expansion of the uterus. It looks pinkish in first pregnancy, in subsequent pregnancy both pinkish and white striae are visible (Striae albican).



Maternal Weight Gain

The total weight gain during the course of a singleton pregnancy for a healthy woman averages 11kg. 1kg in first trimester (1-3 months). 5 kg each in second (4-6 months) and third trimester (7-9 months).

Ideally the weight gain depends on pre-pregnancy body mass index (BMI) level. Weight gain for a woman with normal BMI (20-26) is 11 to 16kg. An obese woman (BMI>29) should not gain more than 7 kg. Where as an underweight woman (BMI<19) may be allowed to gain upto 18kg.

Maternal weight gain 6 kg

- Increase blood volume 1.3 kg
- Increase in extracellular fluid 1.2 kg
- Accumulation of fat and protein 3.5 kg

Reproductive weight gain 6 kg

- Fetus 3.3 kg
- Placenta – 0.6 kg
- Liquor (amniotic fluid)-0.8 kg
- Uterus-0.9 kg
- Breast – 0.4 kg

Systemic Changes

Respiratory System:

Because of enlargement of the uterus, there is an elevation of the diaphragm and breathing becomes diaphragmatic. Upper respiratory tract mucosa becomes congested. The respiratory rate rises to from 18 to 20 breathes per minute to meet demand of fetus. Decreased functional residual capacity 1.7 to 1.35 litres due to the compression of the diaphragm by the uterus.

Cardiovascular Changes:

The heart enlarges by 70 to 80ml due to small increase in wall thickness and venous filling. Cardiac output increases from 4.5 - 6.0 litre/min. Heart rate increases from 70bpm in non-pregnant state to 78bpm at 20 weeks gestation and a peak around 85 bpm in late pregnancy.

Haematological Changes

Blood volume increases by 40-50% at 30-32 weeks of pregnancy. It causes Haemodilution. Haematocrit decreases. The number of white

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